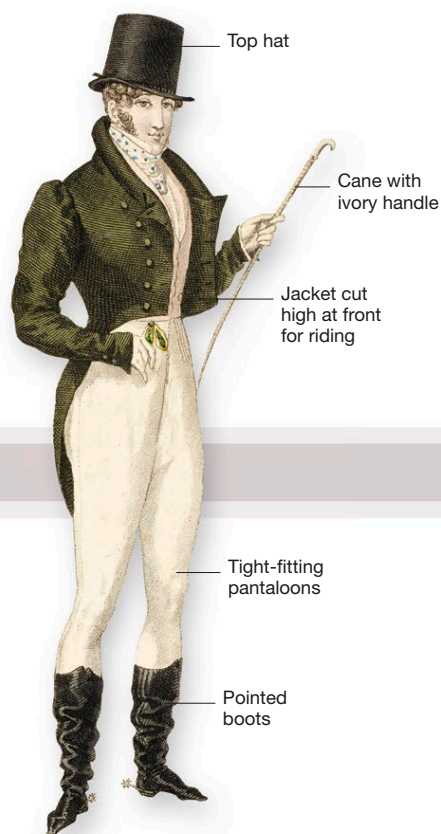


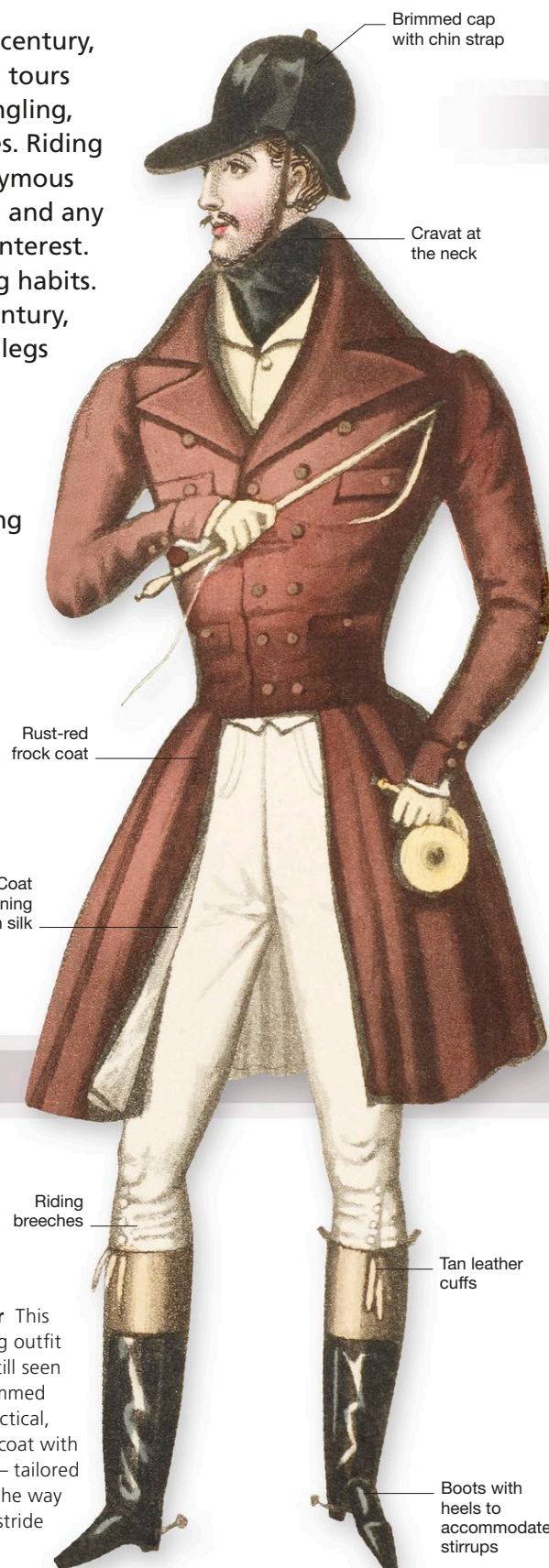
1790–1840

REGENCY SPORTSWEAR

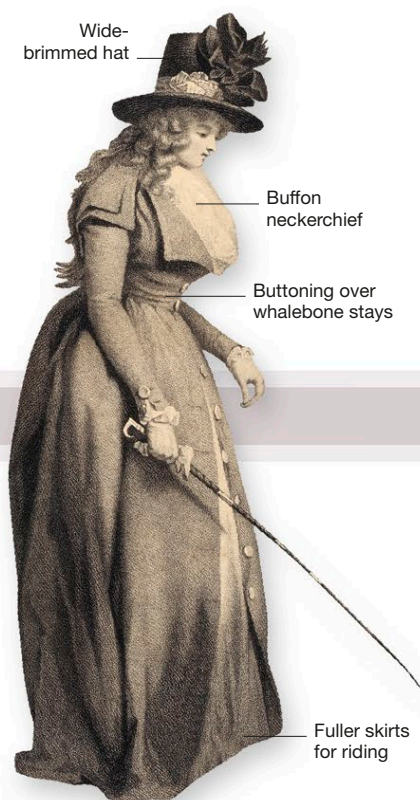
As leisure time increased in the early 19th century, men took up a variety of sports. Walking tours and excursions, hunting and hawking, angling, cricket, and ice skating were all popular pastimes. Riding dress and morning dress were frequently synonymous because riding was considered a morning sport, and any dashing young man would at least pretend an interest. Women's sporting dress mainly comprised riding habits. Women rode side saddle until the end of the century, so skirts were very long by 1840 to ensure their legs were fully covered as they rode. They also wore habits for travelling in open or closed carriages, for walking, and for boating. "Seaside bathing habits" were worn for promenading by the sea but not for immersion. Tailors and the burgeoning ready-to-wear industry worked hard to meet the demand for all the assorted outfits.



Morning outfit This outfit is a variation on Regency town wear, but the green coat marks it out as a morning riding outfit, with tight pantaloons and flexible leather boots.



Hunting wear This style of hunting outfit from 1830 is still seen today. The brimmed hard cap is practical, as is the frock coat with cutaway front – tailored to stay out of the way when sitting astride the horse.



Riding habit Dating from the early 1790s, this riding habit buttons through the skirts like a man's greatcoat, and has large lapels and double shoulder flaps for added protection. Stays pull in at the waist.



Travelling coat A pardessus or overcoat could be worn over a smart outfit. Superfine broadcloth was popular for such coats. The light colour is suitable for summer but the wide shoulder cape will keep off the rain.